Edelman Trust Barometer 2025 × PatientPartner

Special Report | Trust & Health

Trust Is the New Currency:
How Peer-to-Patient Mentorship Is Currently The ***Most Impactful Trigger*** For Treatment Decision Making

Why This Report Matters

In 2025, institutional trust in healthcare is at an all-time low—but peer trust is surging. Edelman's latest data reveals that patients increasingly look to one another before making critical treatment decisions. This one-pager distills the most powerful findings and shows how PatientPartner's real-time mentorship platform turns rising peer trust into measurable patient engagement and ROI.

Top 5 Trust Insights from Edelman 2025

1. Peer Trust Parity: 53% of patients now trust fellow patients (peers) as much as they trust scientists and clinicians.

2. Friends & Family vs. Professionals: 72% say they rely on advice from friends/family almost as much as from doctors (82%).

3. Peer Advice in Action: 34% of patients report having followed peer recommendations instead of professional guidance.

4. Empathy Beats Authority: "Someone who's walked in my shoes" ranks #1 among drivers of patient trust—above credentials.

5. Institutional Trust Gap: Fewer than half trust any single health institution "to do what's right," creating a critical opening for peer-driven solutions.

The PatientPartner Advantage:
Turn Peer Trust into Patient Actions

1. Instant, Real-Time Matching: Patented algorithm connects prospects with vetted mentors who share their exact conditions and experiences—when they need it most.

2. Compliance-First Framework: Built-in KMS monitoring and adverse-event flagging within an ISO 27001, HIPAA, SOC 2, GDPR-approved platform.

3. Data-Driven Outcomes: Live dashboards quantify the impact of peer mentorship:

+68% lift in new patient starts
+29% improvement in long-term adherence
3× ROI on patient engagement spend

How to Leverage These Insights

Download the Full Edelman Report & DTP Trends: Get the complete 2025 Trust Barometer and our Direct-to-Patient Marketing Trends guide in one package.

Book a Personalized Demo See how "PEERscription" can be embedded within your patient support, marketing, or clinical trial teams.

Strategic Planning Session
Apply these trust insights to build a low-lift, high-impact peer mentorship program in under 3 months.

Contact & Next Steps

George Kramb, CEO (PatientPartner)
george@patientpartner.com

Edelman Health Practice
health@edelman.com

Download Now

Schedule a Demo

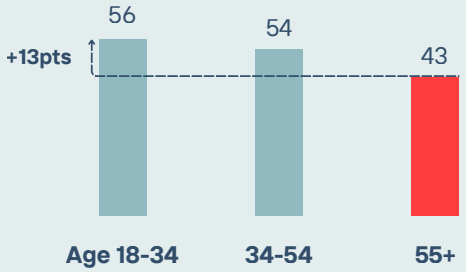
Relatability: To Enter Youth Health Ecosystem, Leverage Information Sources

Percent trust to tell the truth about health issues and how to protect public health

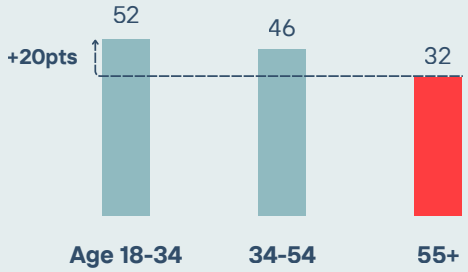
GLOBAL 15

Distrust (1-49) | Neutral (50-59) | Trust (60-100)

I trust people online with **similar health conditions as me**



I trust **individual content creators** with medical training



To Address Full Range of Health Issues,Majority Supplement Provider With Other Voices

Among those who have a healthcare provider they see regularly (73%), percent who say

My healthcare provider is slightly or not qualified to take care of my full range of health issues across physical, mental, social, and environmental dimensions (net)

53%

If my provider is not able to address, I go to these sources:

NON-INSTITUTIONAL (net)	**65**
‣ Friends and family ‣ Online search ‣ Social media	
INSTITUTIONAL (net)	**41**
‣ Institutional health websites ‣ Relevant healthcare company websites ‣ Relevant NGO websites	
COMMUNITIES (net)	**29**
‣ Relevant online communities ‣ Patient advocacy groups	
I still go to my healthcare provider	**24**

Empathy and Accessibility: Learn From What Uncredentialed Voices Offer Patients

Among those who listen to and are influenced by health voices without medical degrees (34%), percent who say

I get each of the following from uncredentialed voices that I do not get from healthcare providers:

Top 5 of 11

- **#1** Empathy for my situation
- **#2** Direct experience of my issue
- **#3** Knowledge of health issues affecting people like me
- **#4** Explanations I can understand
- **#5** Convenience of interaction

Influence Over My Health Decisions: After Providers, Peers On Par With Scientists

Each of the following have influenced my health decisions

		Age 18-34	35-54	55+
My doctor	86	82	86	89
My friends and family	69	74	71	62
Medical scientists and health experts	69	72	70	64
People with similar health conditions as me	42	53	45	28
Content creators without medical training	21	33	23	9